



Partly sunny 80/65 • Tomorrow: Mostly cloudy 75/63 **B18**

Democracy Dies in Darkness

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DEA pitch for Mexico strikes met with alarm

White House, Pentagon rebuffed idea, illustrating split over cartel strategy

BY DAN LAMOTHE
AND ELLEN NAKASHIMA

Drug Enforcement Administration officials advocated for a series of military strikes in Mexico earlier this year, alarming some in the White House and Pentagon and presaging the fraught debate underway in Washington over the legality of this month's deadly attacks on alleged drug traffickers in the Caribbean Sea, people familiar with the matter said.

The discussion began in the opening weeks of President Donald Trump's return to office, after he designated numerous Latin American cartels and criminal gangs as foreign terrorist organizations. DEA officials suggested both targeted killings of cartel leadership in Mexico and attacks on infrastructure there, these people said. Some spoke on the condition of anonymity to share details of highly sensitive and private internal deliberations.

The pushback on DEA's advocacy, which has not been reported previously, illustrates the divisions that have arisen as the Trump administration has taken an aggressive posture toward combating what it says is a major adversary poisoning American citizens. And though DEA's proposals for Mexico have not been acted upon, this month's strikes on alleged drug boats from Venezuela show the administration's determination to unleash deadly force despite internal legal con-

SEE CARTELS ON A7

Trump, Xi bless deal for spin-off of TikTok

Long-sought agreement aims to get around ban on Chinese app in U.S.

BY DREW HARWELL

TikTok has gotten a green light to spin off a new entity in the United States under different ownership as part of a long-awaited deal designed to sidestep a legally mandated ban of the wildly popular video app nationwide.

The approval came Friday after President Donald Trump and Chinese President Xi Jinping concluded a call on which they discussed the app, which has 170 million U.S. users and is currently owned by the Chinese tech giant ByteDance.

The Chinese government, which had criticized a potential sale, said that it welcomed businesses to "conduct commercial negotiations based on market rules" and that it believed the U.S. would support "the consultations between the two teams to properly resolve the TikTok issue," Chinese state media reported.

In a post on Truth Social shortly after, Trump said he and Xi had "made progress on ... the

SEE TIKTOK ON A14



PHOTOS BY MATT MCCLAIN/THE WASHINGTON POST

THE SPACE FORCE READIES FOR A NEW KIND OF WAR

Branch emerges as a vital part of nation's fighting capability amid competition from China, Russia

BY CHRISTIAN DAVENPORT
AT JOINT BASE PEARL HARBOR-HICKAM, HAWAII

It looked more like a satellite television dish than a weapon. But the antenna could fire enough electromagnetic energy to fry the satellite 22,000 miles away.

That was not the plan for tonight's attack, however.

Instead, the salvo would be more covert — millisecond pulses of energy that would subtly disrupt the satellite's signals, which U.S. military forces were using to communicate in the Pacific Ocean. The goal was to disguise the strike as a garbled connection that could be easily remedied by securing a loose cable or a simple reboot, leaving U.S. service members frustrated without raising their suspicions.

This is how the next war could start: invisible shots fired in space on the electromagnetic spectrum that could render U.S. fighter jets and aircraft carriers deaf and blind, unable to communicate. In this case, the "aggressors" targeting the U.S. satellite were not from China or Russia, but rather an elite



TOP: A member of Space Force's 57th Space Aggressors Squadron in Colorado Springs in July. The unit took part in Resolute Space, the force's largest combat training exercise. ABOVE: Space Force Guardians at Joint Base Pearl Harbor-Hickam in Hawaii.

squadron of U.S. Space Force Guardians mimicking how potential adversaries would act in a conflict that begins in orbit.

The July combat training exercise marked the largest one led by the Space Force, the highly secretive branch of the military with an exclusive focus on combating threats in the vast expanse beyond Earth's atmosphere.

More than five years after it was created, the Space Force, the most derided and misunderstood branch of the U.S. military, has emerged as a vital part of the American war machine as space becomes increasingly militarized. But even its leaders acknowledge that they are still honing their mission while jousting with adversaries, such as China, that are moving quickly and conducting combat-like operations in orbit.

Involving more than 700 service members and spanning 50 million square miles and six time zones,

SEE SPACE ON A8



EYAD BABA/AFP/GETTY IMAGES

Ejected from their city as Israel bears down

Palestinians from Gaza City move southward Friday with their belongings as Israel ramps up its ground offensive to seize the city. Families who complete the journey are arriving in al-Mawasi, a tent camp in the southern Gaza Strip where space is limited and disease rampant. **Story and photos, A10-A11**

CDC panel adds hurdle to getting covid shots

Vaccine advisers suggest consulting with clinician before coronavirus jab

BY LENA H. SUN,
RACHEL ROUBEIN
AND DAVID OVALLE

ATLANTA — A federal vaccine advisory panel unanimously voted Friday on a more restrictive approach to coronavirus vaccines by recommending that everyone consult a clinician before getting a shot. The shift creates a complication for Americans who for years were able to get a free shot without having to justify it.

The Advisory Committee on Immunization Practices to the Centers for Disease Control and Prevention eliminated its past recommendations for all Americans ages 6 months and older to receive annual coronavirus shots. In-

stead, it recommends the vaccines under "shared clinical decision-making," meaning people should first consult a medical professional. The full practical implications are unclear. A proposal to encourage states and localities to explicitly require prescriptions for coronavirus vaccines narrowly failed.

"There's going to be some confusion and some fallout that has to get sorted, and it could ultimately be that people in some states face some barriers that they didn't," said Jennifer Kates, a senior vice president at KFF, a health policy research organization. "In general, everyone will have an extra step that they haven't had before."

The Food and Drug Administration in August narrowed approval of updated coronavirus vaccines to those age 65 and older and people with underlying conditions that elevate their risk for severe disease. The ACIP recommendations appear to be more restrictive for seniors by requiring

SEE VACCINE ON A5

IN THE NEWS

Edict for the press The Pentagon demanded that journalists sign a pledge not to obtain classified material or lose their credentials. **A2**

Trump: 'Take it down' The White House Peace Vigil, widely considered the longest continuous political protest in U.S. history, was dismantled by federal law officers. **B13**

THE NATION
Lawmakers introduced a bipartisan bill in the House to exempt coffee from tariffs. **A3**
In California, housing legislation aims to address the state's affordability crisis. **A3**

THE WORLD
An Israeli strike killed 31 journalists in Yemen, a press freedom group said in a report. **A6**
Dmitry Kozak, a critic of the war in Ukraine, left Vladimir Putin's administration. **A7**

THE ECONOMY
With the suspension of Jimmy Kimmel's show, FCC chief Brendan Carr has become the personification of Trump's crusade against media. **A13**
The FTC is suing Ticketmaster and its parent company, Live Nation, alleging "deceptive" resale tactics. **A13**

STYLE
Passages in Kamala Harris's memoir about two Democrats she weighed as ticket mates draw pushback. **B1**

SPORTS
Jayden Daniels, who has a knee sprain, is out and QB Marcus Mariota will start in Sunday's Raiders game. **B7**

THE REGION
A man has been charged with a hate crime after the killing of a transgender woman in D.C. this summer. **B13**
An encounter between candidates during early voting in Virginia became an impromptu demonstration of political civility. **B13**

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